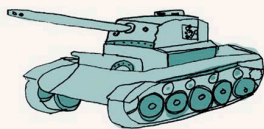




But Leonardo was distinguished by more than just his artistic and technical skills.



As Vasari explained, “His great strength could restrain the most violent fury, and he could bend an iron knocker or a horseshoe

as if it were lead.” His personal warmth also set him apart. “He was liberal to his friends, rich and poor, if they had talent and worth; and indeed as Florence had the greatest of gifts in his birth, so she suffered an infinite loss in his death.”

The reality of that loss showed how highly Leonardo had been regarded during his own life. Yet Leonardo was a man far ahead of his time as well. Among his many ideas that would become realities hundreds of years later were the tank, the helicopter, the bicycle, and the submarine. He devised levers and cranes and screws that could perform in ways never thought of before.

